Table 5.1 Differences among an AWS account root user, IAM user, and IAM role

	AWS account root user	IAM user	IAM role
Can have a password (needed to log in to the AWS Management Console)	Always	Yes	No
Can have access keys (needed to send requests to the AWS API (e.g., for CLI or SDK)	Yes (not recommended)	Yes	No
Can belong to a group	No	Yes	No
Can be associated with an EC2 instance, ECS container, Lambda function	No	No	Yes

By default, users and roles can't do anything. You have to create an identity policy stating what actions they're allowed to perform. IAM users and IAM roles use identity policies for authorization. Let's look at identity policies next.

5.3.3 Defining permissions with an IAM identity policy

By attaching one or multiple IAM identity policies to an IAM user or role, you are granting permissions to manage AWS resources. Identity policies are defined in JSON and contain one or more statements. A statement can either allow or deny specific actions on specific resources. You can use the wildcard character `*` to create more generic statements.